

Tao Louie Lunhe Xu, MSc

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Upcoming PhD student of the political economy of development at SOAS, studying the micro-foundations of industrial policy and political settlements from a perspective of ideological & institutional change. Graduated with the highest distinction from NUFE and a merit from Edinburgh. Proficient in Stata, NVivo, ArcMap, Python, and open to qualitative & quantitative methodologies, with industrial and academic experience across CITIC, Mazars, Deloitte, Duke Kunshan, HQSW, NUFE, UoEdin, UoSheff, SUFE, Fudan, and several public & private organisations. Seeking professional challenges in international research universities to apply my knowledge of real-world economics and a transferable skill set.

SKILLS & RESEARCH INTERESTS

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| ▪ Institutional Political Economy of Development and Change | ▪ Political Settlements Framework | ▪ Evolutionary Institutional and Development Economics |
| ▪ Institutional & Ideological Change | ▪ Distribution of Power and Rents | ▪ Critical Urban, International & Global Development Studies |
| ▪ Industrial Policy and Development | ▪ Micro-foundations of Industrial Policy & Political Settlements | |

QUALIFICATIONS & AWARDS

D.Phil. Economics (Development Economics) - SOAS University of London, Jun 2030 (Expected)

Dissertation Topic: (*Working Title*) Who Secured the Ladder? Industrial Policy Micro-foundations, Ideological Change, and Political Settlements

Supervisor: Antonio Andreoni, Ph.D., Full Professor of Development Economics

Key Modules: Research Methods for Development Economics · Schools of Thought in Economics · Political Economy of Growth and Development · Political Economy of Institutions · Development Macroeconomics & Microeconomics

M.Sc. Development Studies (International Development Studies, Merit) - The University of Edinburgh, Nov 2024

Dissertation Topic: The Road Not Taken? Industrial Policy and Political Settlements in China and Indonesia 1990–2022

Supervisor: Hazel Gray, Ph.D., Senior Lecturer (Associate Professor) in African Studies & International Development

Key Modules: Anthropology of International Development · Political Economy of Development · Resource Politics and Development · Development Institutions & Practices · Poverty and Governance in Africa · Sustainability · Research Design

B.Sc. Economics (Industrial & Commercial Economics, 1st: 91.29) - Nanjing University of Finance & Economics, Jun 2023

Dissertation Topic: Towards Sustainable Prosperity? Policy Evaluation of Jiangsu Advanced Manufacturing Clusters

Supervisor: Yabei Hu, Ph.D., Full Professor of Industrial Economics

Key Modules: Microeconomics · Macroeconomics · Econometrics · International Economics · Regional Market and Interregional Trade · Regional & Urban Economics · Business Economics · Industrial Organisation · Marketing · Platform Economics · Retailing and Wholesaling Studies · Business Design & Innovation · Economic History

Winter/Summer Schools, Workshops & Seminars

Organisational Theory & Methodology: Race, Equity, and Power in Organisations, PhD - Stanford University, Jul 2026

Emerging Issues in Law: AI, Crypto & Global Change, Adv - University of Bradford, Jun 2026

Research Methodology in Applied Economics, Adv - Nanjing Agricultural University, Aug 2023, 2025, 2026

Frontiers in Microeconomics & Econometrics, Adv - Shanghai University of Finance and Economics, Jul 2025, 2026

AI in Economic Theory & Methodology, Adv - University of Chinese Academy of Sciences, Jul 2024, 2025, 2026

Marxian Political Economy, Adv - Wuhan University, *Jul 2023, 2024*

Big Data Analytics in GISciences, Adv - Nanjing Normal University, *Aug 2023*

International Business Management, Prof David French - UCLA & University of Saint Joseph, *Jan 2022*

Firm Innovation Strategy Seminar, Profs Xiaobo Wu & Wenwei Xu - Fudan Centre for Technovation Strategy, *Dec 2025*

Landlord State and Precarious Urban Agriculture in Accra, Prof Dzodzi Tsikata - Edinburgh CAS, *Mar 2024*

Political Economy of Extractivist Development in Ghana, Dr Gertrude Torvikey - Edinburgh CAS, *Nov 2023*

Skills, Courses & Certifications

Econometrics, Text Analytics & GISciences: Stata · NVivo · ArcMap · Python · VOSviewer · Matlab · CiteSpace

Communication & IT Literacy: (NCRE L2) Access · Excel · Publisher · Canva

AI, Justice, and the Rule of Law - UNESCO and Saïd Business School & Blavatnik School of Government at Oxford

Global Development Management, Seeing Institutions in Different Ways, Keynesian Economics - The Open University

Korean Economic Development - Yonsei University · Local Economic Development - Erasmus University Rotterdam

Understanding Research Methods - SOAS University of London · Game Theory - UBC and Stanford University

Microeconomics, Economics of Health Care Delivery, Comparative Health Systems - University of Pennsylvania

Health Systems Development, Epidemiology - University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill and Imperial College London

New Structural Economics, Advanced Quantitative Social Research, Science of Logic - Peking University and CUF

Honours & Awards

Jiangsu Provincial Distinguished UG Dissertation Award 1st Class (77 1st-class works/over 732k graduates)

Jiangsu Provincial Government Scholarship for Overseas Studies

NUFE Principal's Scholarship

NUFE Distinguished UG Dissertation Award (11/3956)

NUFE Honours Graduate (*Summa Cum Laude*)

NUFE Merit Scholarship for Academic Excellence (Dean's List)

NUFE Honours Student

NUFE Merit Scholarship for High Calibre (Best Performance Prize)

NNU Outstanding Student Award

WHU Outstanding Student & Distinguished Paper Award (19/~1300)

NAU Outstanding Student Award

Professional Memberships & Activities

Association for Social Economics · Development Studies Association · Law Society of England & Wales · Rethinking Economics · Union for Radical Political Economics · World Economics Association

PUBLICATIONS

- "Towards Sustainable Prosperity? Policy Evaluation of Jiangsu Advanced Manufacturing Clusters," with Yabei Hu*, *Technology in Society*, 2024, 102583, honoured by Jiangsu Provincial Distinguished Dissertation Award

WORKING PAPERS

- "Why Cities Backfire? High-Speed Railway New Town Planning and Urban Structural Change," with Yi Zhu*, 2025
- "When Polanyi Met Schumpeter: Social Trust and Entrepreneurship," with Weiwei Zhu, 2025, MPRA 123894
- "Reinterpreting the Political Settlements Framework with Structuration Theory," 2024, SocArXiv nmvhq
- "The Road Not Taken? Industrial Policy and Political Settlements in China and Indonesia 1990–2022," 2024, supervised by Dr Hazel Gray
- "It Takes Three to Ceilidh: Pension System and Multidimensional Poverty Mitigation in China," with Yansong Wang*, and Cheng Yuan, 2024, arXiv 2411.02807, (2025 Apr) Birmingham Business School-Nanjing Audit University Institute of Economics International Conference on Ageing, Inequality, and Sustainable Development
- "Peasant Life in Changing China: Rural Pension System Reform and Social Insurance Participation," with Zhengyi Hu, advised by Dr Yongliang Wu, 2022, arXiv 2204.00785

REPORTS, PRESENTATIONS & BOOK REVIEWS

- “Strategic Practices, Multilayered Entrepreneurial Ecosystems, and Firm Digital Transformation: A Case of Emerging EV Charger Giant, StarCharge,” 2026, Fudan Development Institute, Shanghai
- “Endogenous Innovation of Firms: A Cross-layered Analytical Framework,” with Li Liu, *Fudan Report Series*, 2025, 153(37), December, Fudan Development Institute, Shanghai; “Endogenous Innovation in the Tech Cold War Era”
- “Building Connectivity for Inclusive Global Development: A Perspective from Global South,” with Li Liu*, 2025, Pontificia Universidad Católica del Perú–South African BRICS Think Tank & Human Sciences Research Council, Dubai; “Partnership-based Connectivity for Inclusive Global Development: Perspectives and Practices from China–Global South Agri-food Value Chains,” (2025 Dec) Fudan–Latin American FLAUC Annual Conference, Lima
- “Digital Social Innovation and Emerging Industries: A Case of China’s NEV Industrial Policy Evolution,” with Li Liu, 2025, Fudan Development Institute–Shanghai Technology Commission, Shanghai
- “Gu Yanwu’s Neoclassical Confucianism and Entrepreneurship in Contemporary Kunshan, China,” with Xiaoyi Tao, 2025, Kunshan Federation of Humanities and Social Sciences Circles, Kunshan
- “Economic Growth, Poverty Mitigation, and Social Policy in our Neoliberal Era: A Polanyian Perspective,” 2024, Edinburgh & Kunshan
- “Turbulence and Order in Economic Development: Economic Transformation in Tanzania and Vietnam by Hazel Gray,” 2024, Edinburgh
- “Belt of Productivity, Road to Equality: People First Infrastructure Development in Indonesia,” 2023, Edinburgh
- “Having People, Having Heart: Charity, Sustainable Development, and Problems of Dependence in Central Uganda by China Scherz,” 2023, Edinburgh
- “Common Prosperity and the Middle Class,” *WHU Proceedings of the Summer Institute on Marxian Economics*, 2023, 4, 1–5, Wuhan
- “The Theory of Economic Development by Joseph Schumpeter,” 2022, Nanjing
- “A Study of History by Arnold Toynbee,” 2021, Nanjing
- “Eudemonia and Freedom: Frontiers and Evolution of Employment Studies in China,” with Weiwei Zhu, advised by Prof Dr Wenwu Zhang, 2021, MPRA 112908, Nanjing
- “Survey on Local Pharmaceutical Specialty Stores: Retail Formats and Elements,” with Yukun Gu, Yibo Wang, Dapeng Zhu, Wei Li, Zhenyu Zhang, Jingxia Hou, and Yuhang Yang, advised by Prof Jinguo Tao, 2021, Nanjing
- “Mismatch and Dysfunction of the Ageing Economy: Digital Transformation in Silver-Hair Industry,” with Y. Gu, Y. Wang, and Q. Chen, *Journal of the Jiangsu Association for Commercial Economics*, 2021, 38, 1–9, Nanjing
- “Reshaping Silver-Hair Industry with New Retailing: A SWOT-Based Strategy,” *Journal of the China Federation of Logistics*, 2021, 28, 82–85, Nanjing
- “Survey on the Ageing Society in Rural Guannan: Consumption, Social Security, and Manufacturing for Silver-Hair Economy,” with Yukun Gu and Yibo Wang, advised by Dr Qifei Chen, 2020, Guannan & Nanjing

RESEARCH & PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Fudan University (Shanghai) 2025 – 2027

Co-Investigator - Fudan Development Institute and Hefei University of Technology 2025 – 2027

- Worked on project-oriented research, e.g. ‘*Strategic Optimisation of Global Supply Chain Engagement with Development Zones in China’s Yangtze Economic Belt*’ advised by Dr Li Liu, on 5 assigned projects
- Independently drafted the Shanghai Key Think-Tank Project Proposal ‘*Tech Lead Firm Growth and Gradient-Heterogeneous Policy Toolkit in GVCs Governance*’ with Dr Liu for Shanghai Commission on Technology
- Reviewed cross-disciplinary literature spanning business life cycle, entrepreneurship, evolutionary innovation & industrial policy, authored 2 full reports (30,000+ words)

- Summarised a list of pundits in GVCs and supply chain management for project advisory committee
- Conducted a brief review of 20 papers on green agricultural transformation and sustainable rural livelihoods
- Engaged in Shanghai Forum 2025, reflected on talks by Keun Lee, Takehiko Nakao, Woo Wing Thye, and Michael Levitt on innovation strategy and global techno-nationalist policy change
- Drafted all the sections of a project-based work 'Endogenous Innovation in the Tech Cold War Era'
- Authored a 12,000-word working paper 'Partnership-based Connectivity for Inclusive Global Development', integrating connectivity into institutional design of inclusive GVCs across Asia, Africa, and Latin America
- Drafted 'Rethinking Connectivity' sections for think-tank roundtable discussions, providing policy-relevant perspectives on logistical bottlenecks, financial innovations, and geopolitical choke-points
- Interpreted the dynamic capabilities of endogenous innovation to sense techno-nationalism, seize the market-technology change, and reconfigure resources through technology exploration, market exploitation & ecosystem orchestration under positive externalities of institutional complementarity
- Conducted case-based studies and a historical framing of China's BRI agri-food engagements, compiling evidence from open data, reports, and news into an inclusive global development schema to compare BRI partnership modes and governance structures

Research Associate - Fudan Development Institute and Shanghai Technology Commission 2025

- Worked on the 15th Shanghai Government Consultation Research Awarded Project '*Digital Social Innovation and Emerging Industries*', with my subproject focus on new energy vehicle industry
- Articulated the structure of digital social innovation, its conceptual boundaries, actor subjects, objects, networked ecosystems, agendas, and gaps in social-commercial identity duality & techno-determinism
- Comparatively analysed the industrial change of automotive manufacturing in China, Japan, South Korea, Germany & US, and attributed China's to policy experimentation & clustered innovation
- Mapped China's NEV industrial policy trajectory since the 1990s, marked the shift from R&D incentives (tax credits & grants), public procurements, consumer subsidies towards market competition, full-chain industrial coordination & charging infrastructure provision, and drafted policy reports plus supplementary appendices
- Stylised facts and proposed recommendations on foresight social governance of industrial ecosystems, particularly regulatory gaps in flexible employment, social security, tax compliance, and labour rights

Shanghai University of Finance & Economics (Shanghai) 2024 – 2027

Research Assistant - School of Public Economics & Administration 2024 – 2027

- Reviewed the related work on high-speed railway and structural change, particularly on agglomeration economies, network-spillover effects of diffusion & the core-periphery framework, studied City Economics by O'Flaherty and Handbook of Regional & Urban Economics by Duranton, Henderson, Thisse, and Cheshire
- Advised on 'Impact of High-Speed Railway New Town Construction on Land Prices' with Prof Dr Yi Zhu
- Employed the DiD approach, illustrated that HSR town planning in Yangtze Delta cities inhibits the average unit labour productivity of tertiarisation in hub cities but facilitates industrialisation in non-hub ones
- Examined the siphoning of the services in East China that labour & economic activities over-concentrate in core cities and industrial out-diffusion from hub cities enhancing secondary output of non-core areas
- Drafted 'Why Cities Backfire? High-Speed Railway New Town Planning and Urban Structural Change'

Peer Advisor - College of Business 2024

- Advised on a Master's dissertation 'Impact of Regional Trade Agreements on Export Resilience' supervised by Prof Dr Linke Zhu, mentored in research design and writing

Peer Advisor - Nanjing University Department of Finance (Nanjing) 2023 – 2025

- Mentored MPhil students in new structural economics, advised on economics causal inference & Bartik-IV

- Facilitated collaboration between students and PIs from Tsinghua PBC School of Finance & Peking Guanghua School of Management, supported studies on political trust in govt, SOE reform, and economic insecurity

Nanjing University of Finance & Economics (Nanjing)

2019 – 2024

Co-Investigator & Research Associate - School of International Economics & Business

2022 – 2024

- Worked on National Social Science Fund of China Programme '*Optimisation of Industrial Ecosystems for Advanced Manufacturing Clusters Based on Producer Services*' supervised by Prof Dr Yabei Hu
- Selected, compiled, and perused the publicly available policy documents issued by corresponding functional departments of the Jiangsu government, qualitatively summarised the relevance of the gist
- Deployed a mixed methodology by a triple analytical framework, scrutinised policy themes, instruments & controls through textual mining and PMC index modelling with a dataset of 52 official documents
- Independently conducted data collection, visualisation, drafting & submission
- Produced original research paper 'Towards Sustainable Prosperity? Policy Evaluation of Jiangsu Advanced Manufacturing Clusters' published in *Technology in Society*, honoured by Provincial Distinguished Award

Conductor Assistant & Principal Second Bass - NUFE Choir

2019 – 2023

Co-Investigator & Coordinator - School of International Economics & Business

2021 – 2022

- Worked on National 'Culture, Science & Health to Rural China' Programme '*Cultural Heritage and Industrial Organisation in Less-Developed Areas*' with Weiwei Zhu, honoured by National Excellent Award, Provincial Special Award, and NUFE Best Report Award 1st Class
- Cooperated with the Shuyang government, conducted modern history investigation to organise specialised educational lecture series tailored to regional cultural endowments
- Introduced media campaigns across WeChat, Tiktok & Weibo for more visibility and accessibility of cultural heritage, integrate public participation into cultural preservation, tourism & economic development

Team Leader - Chinese Society for Optimisation & Economic Mathematics

2021

- Worked on 'MathorCup' Mathematical Contest in Modelling with Yansong Wang and Yukun Gu

Lead Investigator - School of International Economics & Business

2020 – 2021

- Initiated '*Reshaping Silver-Hair Industry with New Retailing: A Story of China*' with Dr Qifei Chen
- Led the project from inception to completion, not limited to fundraising, recruitment, duty allocation, and resource coordination to ensure timely delivery of research goals
- Managed online surveys targeting younger individuals, adopted an intergenerational perspective to analyse the influence of younger generations on the familiarity of older adults with smart devices & online shopping
- Reviewed the literature on 'new retailing' in the 'silver-hair economy', investigated market challenges in an ageing society, organised fieldwork in Guannan, interviewed older adults face-to-face to capture their very nuanced demands, consumption behaviour & digital technology adoption
- Identified the supply-demand mismatch in the silver-hair industry, proposed actionable strategy of big data in e-commerce logistics for rural & urban fringe areas, recommended by Tibet Chief Secretary Chunlai Zhou
- Published 2 reports '*Reshaping Silver-Hair Industry with New Retailing*' & '*Mismatch and Dysfunction of the Ageing Economy*', drafted 1 working paper '*Rural Pension System Reform and Social Insurance Participation*' with feedback from a Bangkok-based World Bank economist

Student Assistant - NUFE Admissions Committee

2019 – 2021

Research Assistant - School of Business Administration

2020

- Worked on Jiangsu Administration for Market Regulation Programme '*Customer Satisfaction Evaluation of Tertiary Sector*', ensured public participation of online surveys and collected data

Coordinator Assistant (Intern) - Duke Kunshan University Office of Student Affairs (Kunshan)	2023
- Facilitated liaison among students, faculty & leadership, handled administrative operations of event logistics, copyright license agreements, reimbursements, bilingual brochure & yearbook editions, and other duties - Supported Campus Engagement student worker recruitment & training, interviewed for FYSAC Chairs (14), Orientation Leaders (107) & Commencement Volunteers (97), coordinated events, visualised survey data	
Advisor Assistant (Intern) - Deloitte Division of Tax (Suzhou)	2021
- Co-drafted a 42-page report with my focus on fixed assets, intangible assets, tax credits, inventories & cross-border intra-group financing, translated 3 appendices, and selected 8/517 CUP comparables with TP Catalyst - Advised on tax incentives & industrial layouts for foreign-invested manufacturers in Yangtze Delta and liaised with Xiamen SAFE Bureau & investment promotion agencies on intra-group capital reallocation accounting	
Audit Assistant (Intern) - Mazars Division of Audit (Suzhou)	2021
- Assisted with annual audits of Xiangcheng collective assets and Kunshan Hi-Tech Group, with my focus on P&L statement, balance sheet, large transaction, and state-owned asset confirmation - Drafted 31 report sections and independently produced 7 audit working papers	
Consultant Assistant (Intern) - CITIC Division of Wealth Management (Kunshan)	2020
Executive & Consultant Associate - HQSW Agency for Foreign Affairs Administration (Kunshan)	2020 – 2022
Research Assistant - Administration for Market Regulation & Bureau of Finance (Kunshan)	2018 – 2020

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Language Proficiency

Fluent in English (IELTS Academic C1) and Mandarin with a good understanding of Wu and Literary Chinese

Peer Review

PLoS One · Heliyon · Journal of Infrastructure Policy and Development · World Development Sustainability · Journal of Chinese Governance

Referee List

Antonio Andreoni, PhD (Cambridge Centre of Development Studies)

Full Professor

Department of Economics & Centre for Sustainable Structural Transformation

SOAS University of London

aa155@soas.ac.uk

Yi Zhu, PhD (MIT Department of Urban Studies & Planning)

Associate Professor

School of Public Economics and Administration

Shanghai University of Finance and Economics

zhu.yi@sufe.edu.cn

Hazel Gray, PhD (SOAS Department of Economics)

Senior Lecturer (Associate Professor)

School of Social and Political Science

The University of Edinburgh

hazel.gray@ed.ac.uk

Tao (Louie) Clovis Lunhe Xu 许翀 3rd April 2026